Modern Savage — Bear's Instagram Pre-Launch Content Arc

Prepared: April 28, 2026

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For: Calvin + Jesse — approve before Jesse sails May 7. Olly executes May 7-21.

Window: May 1 – July 1 (Launch Day)

Platform: Bear Grylls Instagram (@beargrylls, ~12M followers)

The Problem This Solves

Every launch document assumes Bear's Instagram audience is primed for Modern Savage. They're not. Not yet.

When the launch email lands on July 1, Bear's followers should already have a faint, subconscious picture forming: *Bear takes his nutrition seriously. Bear does something unusual with food. Bear has been building something.* That picture doesn't come from ads. It comes from 8 weeks of organic content that doesn't mention a product at all — until it does.

This brief maps that 8-week arc. The product launch on July 1 should feel like the end of a story the audience didn't realise they were following.

The Golden Rule

Never let the post feel like marketing.

Bear's Instagram has ~12M followers because they trust him. The moment a post feels like an ad, that trust is borrowed against. Modern Savage content on Bear's account should pass the "would Bear post this anyway?" test at every stage except the launch reveal.

If Calvin is ever unsure whether a post crosses that line: ask whether a non-supplement Bear post with identical copy and no CTA would look unusual. If the answer is yes, the post has product-marketing energy and needs to be reframed.

Content Arc Overview

Phase	Dates	Theme	Modern Savage Ref
Phase 1 — Foundation	May 1-21	Morning ritual + real food	None — zero product mentions

Phase	Dates	Theme	Modern Savage Ref
Phase 2 — The Nutrition Thread	May 22 - June 14	Ancestral food + body as tool	One subtle hint only
Phase 3 — The Build	June 15-28	"Something coming"	Growing tease arc
Phase 4 — Launch	June 29 - July 1	Reveal + launch	Full product reveal

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Phase 1 — Foundation (May 1–21)

While Jesse is sailing. Olly approves.

Goal: Plant the morning ritual and whole-food narrative without any supplement context. The audience builds a picture of what Bear does before anything hard. No product. No hint. Just Bear.

Post 1 — The Before-Coffee Ritual

Type: Photo — Bear at home, early morning, glass of water

Copy concept:

> *"The first thing I do in the morning isn't coffee. It's not email. It's this: a glass of cold water, a moment of quiet, and the same quiet discipline I've been building for 20 years. The discipline is the same whether I'm about to film something dangerous or drive kids to school. The body doesn't distinguish. Build the ritual. Let it carry you."*

Why: This is the single most important post in Phase 1. It primes the "morning ritual" frame that Email 3 ("What I do before anything hard") builds on directly. When the email lands, the audience already has context.

Post 2 — The Whole Animal

Type: Photo or Reel — Bear cooking or eating on an expedition or at home

Copy concept:

> *"People always ask what I eat when I'm out there. The honest answer: whatever I can find. And what I've learned over 30 years is that the parts nobody wants are often the parts the body needs most. Our grandparents knew this. We forgot. I'm trying to remember."*

Why: This seeds the ancestral nutrition argument in Bear's authentic voice, in a context (expedition eating) where nobody questions it. No product. No science. Just Bear's honest observation. This copy is a preview of the Modern Savage narrative.

Post 3 — Family at the Table

Type: Photo — Bear with family at dinner (can be non-specific, no need for organ meat content)

Copy concept:

> *"What we put in front of our kids every day is the most important health decision we make. Not a doctor's appointment — the table. I think about this a lot."*

Why: Seeds the family/kids angle. Pre-conditions the audience for the kids blend narrative later. Completely natural Bear content.

Post 4 — Strength Over Time

Type: Photo/video — Bear training, cold plunge, or wilderness

Copy concept:

> *"Real strength isn't how hard you push in the gym. It's how consistently you show up at the foundation. Sleep, movement, nutrition. Not as a philosophy. As a practice. Every day."*

Why: The word "nutrition" appears for the first time, tucked within a broader performance framing. Still no product reference.

Phase 2 — The Nutrition Thread (May 22 – June 14)

Goal: The audience starts connecting Bear to the nutrition conversation specifically. One post introduces a very subtle forward reference — "working on something." The rest continues the organic narrative.

Post 5 — The Liver Post (The Boldest Organic Post)

Type: Photo — Bear actually eating or preparing liver/organ meat, in an expedition or home context

Copy concept:

> *"Liver. People flinch. I get it — it tastes like work. But gram for gram, there is nothing on earth more nutritionally dense. SAS ration packs have included organ meats since WW2 for a reason. When you're running on depleted everything, this is what your body actually reaches for. Our ancestors ate the whole animal without thinking twice. We lost that. I've been thinking about what it would take to get it back — in a form people would actually take."*

Why: This is the clearest ancestral nutrition argument Bear can make on his own account. "In a form people would actually take" — that's the first oblique reference to Modern Savage. One

sentence. Nobody reads it as a product teaser; it reads as Bear being reflective. But when the product launches, early followers will remember this post.

Post 6 — The Recovery Post

Type: Reel or photo — Bear post-training, post-expedition, or in nature

Copy concept:

> *"Recovery isn't rest. It's rebuilding. What you put in matters as much as what you put out. I've spent the last few years trying to rebuild my relationship with how I actually fuel my body. Not performance culture — the older, quieter version of it."*

Why: Reinforces the "Bear takes nutrition seriously" thread. Natural Reel content.

Post 7 — The Hint Post

Type: Photo — simple, clean, Bear at rest

Copy concept:

> *"I've been working on something for a while. It started with a question I couldn't answer satisfactorily: what would I tell my sons to put in their bodies, every day, for the rest of their lives? I'm nearly ready to tell you what I came up with."*

Why: This is the first explicit forward reference. It's personal (sons), it's quiet (not hype), and it invites curiosity without advertising. This post will drive DMs — people will ask. Calvin should monitor and flag genuine inquiry volume to Jesse.

Phase 3 — The Build (June 15–28)

Goal: Escalate deliberately. The audience knows something is coming. The reveal is one week out.

Post 8 — Two Weeks Out (June 15)

Type: Close-up product-adjacent — Bear's hands, morning scene, no packaging visible

Copy concept:

> *"Two weeks. Spent the last two years getting this right. Twice. I got it wrong once. Started over. I'll tell you about both versions when we're live."*

Why: The "I got it wrong and started over" is authentic Modern Savage lore — Bear actually reformulated the product. This is not manufactured drama. Framing the launch with that context builds credibility before the product is even shown.

Post 9 — One Week Out (June 22, ahead of Email 4 "7 days." on June 24)

Type: Minimal — a single word or a stark image, Bear's morning

Copy concept:

> *"7 days."*

Why: Matches Email 4's subject line. Creates an ambient countdown without explaining it. The people who've been following the thread will feel it. New followers will be intrigued.

Post 10 — Soft Launch Day (June 29)

Type: Story only — no feed post

Content: "The 170 people who signed up first are getting early access today. That window closes in 48 hours. Link in bio."

Why: Stories don't disrupt feed continuity. The 48-hour waitlist exclusivity is protected by keeping it in Stories — it doesn't broadcast to the full 12M followers in a way that undermines the "exclusive early access" framing. Feed silence on June 29 is intentional. The waitlist feels genuinely privileged because the general audience doesn't see the post.

Phase 4 — Launch (July 1)

Launch Post — Feed (July 1, 7am UK)

Type: High-quality product photo — the bottle, clean, Bear's hands

Copy concept:

> *"This is Modern Savage.*

Whole organs. Freeze-dried. Nothing added.

It started with a question: what would our ancestors have called a supplement? The answer is: they wouldn't have. They would have eaten the whole animal.

This is what that looks like in 2026. It's taken two years, one false start, and a lot of cold mornings.

The first orders ship today. Link in bio."

Why: Simple. Not hype. The copy echoes the emails the 170 founding members have already read — they'll feel continuity. New audiences get the full context in four sentences.

Launch Story Sequence (July 1)

Story 1: Product shot — "It's live."

Story 2: Brief clip of Bear — "Link in bio. Thank you for waiting."

Story 3: Founding member call-out — "The first 170 people who believed before we launched: this is for you."

What Olly Needs To Execute (May 7–21)

Jesse is at sea. Olly approves all Bear social content via Metricool from May 7.

Olly's specific actions for Modern Savage during the sailing window:

- Approve and schedule Posts 2, 3, 4 (from Phase 1) — no approval complexity, pure organic content
- If Post 5 (the Liver Post) falls during the sailing window: flag to Jesse for approval before sending — the "in a form people would actually take" line is the first MS reference and Jesse should sign off on it

What Olly should NOT do during the sailing window:

- Post anything that mentions Modern Savage by name
- Post the Hint Post (Post 7) — that requires Jesse's approval, should land after May 21
- Approve any content from Calvin that includes product imagery or pricing

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Notes for Calvin

Tone calibration: Every caption in Phases 1-2 should sound like Bear wrote it, not like Bear approved it. Bear's voice is direct, physical, faith-adjacent, and masculine without performing masculinity. Avoid: metrics, superlatives, before/after language, and anything that reads as supplement marketing.

Image direction: Phase 1-2 should use real, slightly imperfect photography — adventure context, morning light, genuine settings. No studio lighting. No pristine product shots until Phase 4. The gap between the raw Phase 1 imagery and the clean Phase 4 product shot should be jarring in a good way — it's the visual proof that something real became something polished.

Subject line mirror: Email subjects ("I owe you an update," "What I do before anything hard," "It's live.") should be reflected in Instagram copy where natural. The subscriber who has read the emails and follows Bear on Instagram should feel like they're getting two simultaneous channels of the same coherent story.

Built April 28, 2026. Jesse to approve overall arc before May 7. Olly covers Phase 1 execution. Jesse approves Phase 2 hint posts on return May 21. Calvin drafts all specific posts against this framework.